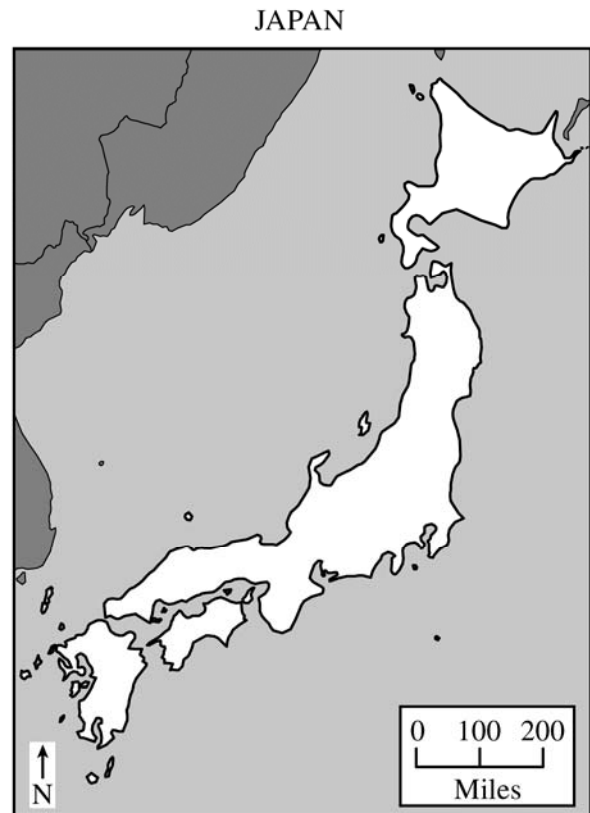
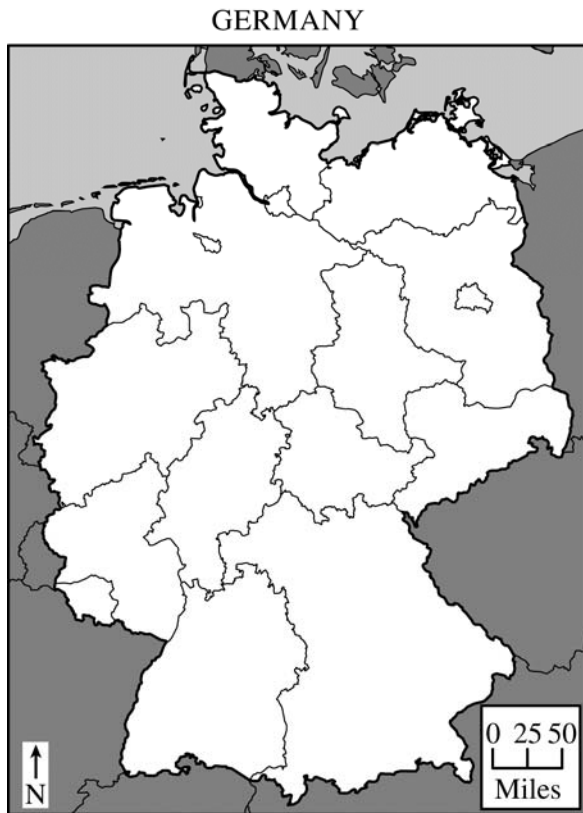


2017 AP[®] HUMAN GEOGRAPHY FREE-RESPONSE QUESTIONS



3. Political geographers classify most countries as either unitary states or federal states.
- A. Define unitary state and identify the country shown that fits the definition of a unitary state.
 - B. Explain ONE positive and ONE negative impact of a unitary system.
 - C. Identify and explain ONE reason why some countries are governed as federal states.

STOP

END OF EXAM

AP[®] HUMAN GEOGRAPHY SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3

6 Points: (2 + 2 + 2)

A. Define unitary state and identify the country shown that fits the definition of a unitary state.

2 points (1 definition + 1 identification)

• **Definition:**

- a country organized in such a way that most power is placed in a central government, or there is limited political power at subnational scales of governance

• **Identification:** Japan

B. Explain ONE positive and ONE negative impact of a unitary system.

2 points (1 positive + 1 negative)

Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
1. Standardization of laws and their implementation across the country 2. Patriotism or pride in one's country is bolstered due to uniformity 3. Efficiencies are achieved through less duplication OR faster countrywide implementation of laws or governmental services across multiple scales 4. Fewer government or taxation agencies, or fewer scales of government or taxation 5. The potential for corruption of local government reduced 6. Creation of a national identity that reduces the potential for devolutionary processes	1. Centralization of power can lead to a disconnect with local areas, minority groups, regional political parties, or disparate regions 2. Marginalization of local cultures through standardization at a country level 3. Central government may not effectively provide services on a subnational scale 4. Decisions and policies of the central government could become dominated by interests of the politically or culturally dominant group 5. Central government bogged down by competing local problems OR slow response to local issues. (e.g., natural disasters, infrastructure, public services)
The term centripetal force alone is not worthy of a point unless there is an explanation related to one of the positive impacts listed above.	The term centrifugal force alone is not worthy of a point unless there is an explanation related to one of the negative impacts listed above.